



(From extreme left) Exhibits and pavilions at the Bharat Mandapam



security and national security as inseparable.

Meanwhile, senior White House AI advisor Sriram Krishnan was direct about what Washington wants: India, like other American allies, should build on the American

AI stack. "At the end of the day," he said, "we want the American AI stack to be something that everyone builds on." That doesn't mean India surrenders its strategic autonomy, he was quick to add.

INDIA'S AI MOMENT

The most significant domestic development of the week was the launch of Sarvam AI's two flagship language models: Sarvam-30B and Sarvam-105B. The Bengaluru-based start-up, which has received both private funding and government support through the IndiaAI Mission, built the models entirely locally, without relying on external data.

The benchmarks drew significant attention. On the olmOCR Bench, Sarvam's Vision model scored about 84.3% accuracy, ahead of Gemini 3 Pro at roughly 80.2% and a ChatGPT vision model in the 69-70% range. On OmniDocBench v1.5, it achieved 93.28% accuracy. It also outperformed DeepSeek-R1, a 600-billion-parameter model from China, on most benchmarks, an especially notable feat for a startup operating at a fraction of its competitors' scale.

The models will be open source, and Sarvam launched a public beta chatbot shortly after the summit. It

has also entered the smart glasses market with the launch of Sarvam Kaze, an AI-powered wearable fully designed and built in India. Kaze is designed to respond to voice commands, listen to users, and capture visuals through embedded cameras.

Two other Indian models also debuted at the Summit. Gnani.ai launched a voice model that works across 12 Indian languages even under low-bandwidth conditions, and BharatGen unveiled a 17-billion-parameter multilingual foundational model built for Indic languages, also offered open source. Tech Mahindra also launched an 8-billion-parameter Hindi-first education LLM under the IndiaAI Mission, becoming the only IT services company selected by the mission to build a foundational LLM.

THE BIGGER PICTURE

India has emerged as a critical growth engine for generative AI platforms. The story is less about frontier breakthroughs than the scale of adoption.

India is betting on building affordable, multilingual, practical technology and exporting it to the developing world, much as its digital payments infrastructure became a global model.

What emerged clearly from the summit is that India no longer intends to be a passive recipient of innovation developed elsewhere. Whether sovereign models will translate into tools that reach farmers or students in government schools, whether announced investments will materialise and whether new forms of employment will offset those displaced by automation all remain open questions. But the signals were clear: the centre of gravity in the global AI conversation is moving. **BT**

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